

Post-incident review PIR-2025-043

Data Warehouse: delayed processing

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 09 July 2025, Data Warehouse experienced delayed processing in production (Southeast Asia) for about 160 minutes. A latency threshold alert fired for the service's main endpoint. Investigation found that a third-party SMS gateway degraded without notice.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw delayed processing for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:10 First signal received.
- 09:34 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:47 Likely cause identified.
- 10:15 Mitigation applied.
- 10:57 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a third-party SMS gateway degraded without notice.

Customer impact was limited because most traffic was served from cache.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.